

Everything announced at GitHub Universe 2020

GitHub held it's virtual event to announce all the things that they've been working on over the course of the past one year. Here's a summary.

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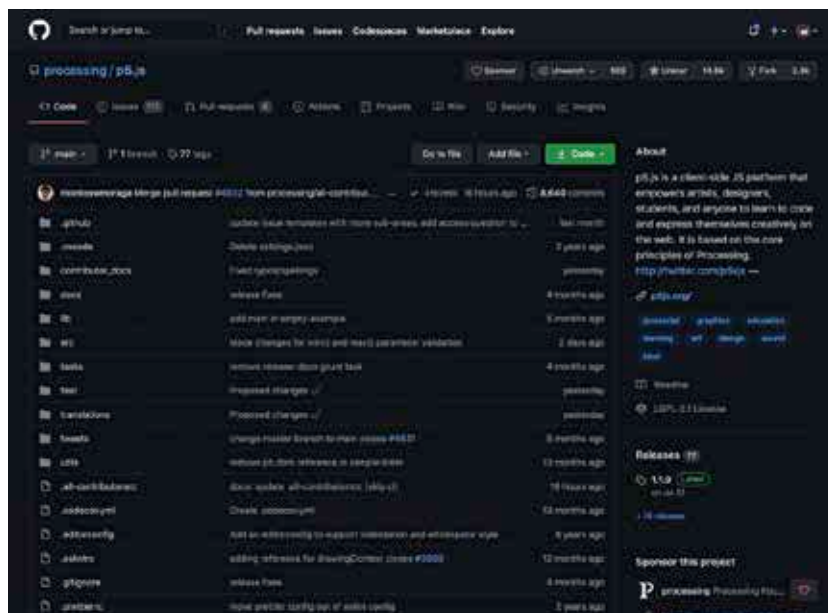
GitHub held its virtual event GitHub Universe in early December and made quite a few major announcements and feature introductions to their platform. Some of which have been requested for ages by developers whereas some have come as a pleasant surprise. Let's take a look at all the major announcements.

GITHUB DARK MODE

Every major IDE or developer tool has implemented dark mode. Since most of the time is spent in the CLI which is inherently dark, switching to GitHub's UI in the middle of a coding session could render you blind for a few seconds. Not anymore. The newest public beta now includes the option to switch on Dark Mode in your settings or you can set it to track your preferences.

DISCUSSIONS

The remote working situation seems to have accelerated another feature. Discussions is a community space for developers to interact with each other, ask questions and have ... well discussions. The feature was



Dark Mode

introduced earlier in March 2020 and has finally hit public beta. With this new aspect, you can think of GitHub coming up with its own version of Stack Overflow-like forums. This is currently available for public repositories and not for private since the older issue tracker is more than sufficient for private repos. Instead of having a separate discussion on Stack Overflow and heading over to the repos, you can now have the discussion within the same ecosystem and involve the folks who've built the project as well. Discussions are currently available on the desktop experience only and the mobile implementation should happen in early 2021.

WORKFLOW IMPROVEMENTS

GitHub is a little daunting for newbies who are generally more comfortable with a GUI rather than a CLI. This meant that new users had to familiarise themselves with a lot of the aspects that govern the workflow

before they could do anything. This year saw several improvements being introduced to the Actions. GitHub introduced environments, required reviewers, deployments and deployment logs and a workflow visualiser. Users can now set up environment protection rules and environment secrets to ensure the code that is meant for deployment undergoes certain checks. The new required reviewers feature will pause your deployment until and unless the stated reviewer approves the deployment themselves. This adds a new layer of accountability to the entire process and we've all heard a few horror stories of broken code being deployed to production environments due to lapses. Once approved, the environment secrets will be accessible and then the code can proceed to deployment.

Which brings us to the visualise aspect. GitHub Actions now has a workflow visualiser that maps the